

07 Aug 2026 02:36:51 ET | 13 pages

Seagate Technology Holdings PLC (STX.N)

Seagate Mgmt Meeting Takeaways: Strengthening Demand and Profitability Ahead

CITI'S TAKE

We met with Seagate IR at the company's Silicon Valley headquarters in conjunction with our [FMS 2026 visit](#) and [meeting lineup](#) and post its [strong June qtr earnings announcement](#). Mgmt highlighted its highly constructive demand and pricing outlook, supported by fully-allocated nearline HDD capacity into CY28 and strengthening AI-driven storage demand. Emerging KV-cache architectures, HAMR adoption, and physical AI workloads could further expand exabyte growth. Mgmt additionally cited strong pricing discipline, limited inventory risk, robust hyperscaler demand visibility, and improving profitability. Reiterate Buy and \$1,300 Target Price. We continue to view STX shares favorably as the company continues to benefit from strong demand for its high-capacity drives, robust margins, and a continued healthy pricing environment well-supported by limited production, ongoing hyperscaler HAMR qualifications/ramp, and where the company continues to undersell industry demand, supportive of pricing power.

We note management's increasing confidence that AI-driven storage demand is broadening beyond training and into inferencing, agentic AI, and eventually physical AI. Seagate mentioned KV cache architectures as a potential incremental HDD demand driver because it allows AI systems to store and re-reference context on lower-cost storage rather than repeatedly recomputing results on expensive GPUs. The company's reference design with a major NAND maker demonstrates a tiered-storage approach where context can be moved economically to HDDs while remaining accessible to AI workloads. While management cannot quantify how much of its long-term 25% exabyte CAGR outlook is attributable to AI, it noted demand signals strengthened recently as AI workloads begin to layer from training into inference and agentic applications. Importantly, management also sees emerging enterprise and on-prem AI deployments adopting these architectures, suggesting AI storage demand may become more diversified beyond hyperscale cloud providers. Continued...

EPS (US\$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons	VA Cons
2025A	1.58A	2.03A	1.90A	2.59A	8.11A	8.10A	8.11A
2026E	2.61A	3.11A	4.10A	5.71A	15.58E	15.58E	15.59E
Previous	2.61A	3.11A	4.10A	5.71A	15.58E	na	na
2027E	7.30E	8.06E	9.01E	10.96E	35.24E	36.37E	37.45E
Previous	7.30E	8.06E	9.01E	10.96E	35.24E	na	na
2028E	12.37E	13.84E	14.60E	16.13E	56.78E	57.02E	64.42E
Previous	12.37E	13.84E	14.60E	16.13E	56.78E	na	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus. VA Cons: Visible Alpha Consensus.

Click [here](#) for Visible Alpha consensus data

Buy

Short-Term View: Upside, expires 11-OCT-26

Price (06 Aug 26 16:00)	US\$851.87
Target price	US\$1,300.00
Expected share price return	52.6%
Expected dividend yield	0.3%
Expected total return	53.0%
Market Cap	US\$193,072M

Price Performance (RIC: STX.N, BB: STX US)



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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

STX.N: Fiscal year end 30-Jun						Price: US\$851.87; TP: US\$1,300.00; Market Cap: US\$193,072m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	6,551	9,097	12,195	18,662	24,835	PE (x)	na	na	54.7	24.2	15.0
Cost of sales	-5,015	-5,897	-6,637	-7,898	-9,380	PB (x)	na	na	79.4	37.7	23.9
Gross profit	1,536	3,200	5,558	10,764	15,454	EV/EBITDA (x)	na	83.0	41.5	19.5	13.1
Gross Margin (%)	23.4	35.2	45.6	57.7	62.2	FCF yield (%)	0.4	0.4	1.6	3.5	6.0
EBITDA (Adj)	941	2,378	4,726	9,989	14,717	Dividend yield (%)	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	14.4	26.1	38.8	53.5	59.3	Payout ratio (%)	217	35	19	8	5
Depreciation	-264	-251	-276	-349	-457	ROE (%)	na	na	na	na	na
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	Cashflow (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBIT (Adj)	677	2,127	4,450	9,640	14,260	EBITDA	686	2,166	4,397	9,897	14,625
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	10.3	23.4	36.5	51.7	57.4	Working capital	386	-965	-159	-605	-437
Net interest	-317	-296	-254	-175	-175	Other	-154	-118	-564	-1,551	-2,267
Associates	0	0	0	0	0	Operating cashflow	918	1,083	3,674	7,741	11,921
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	85	-318	-506	-92	-92	Capex	-254	-265	-569	-962	-1,280
Pre-tax profit	445	1,513	3,690	9,373	13,992	Net acq/disposals	380	-11	44	0	0
Tax	-110	-44	-506	-1,467	-2,184	Other	0	0	0	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	0	0	0	0	Investing cashflow	126	-276	-525	-962	-1,280
Reported net profit	335	1,469	3,184	7,906	11,809	Dividends paid	-585	-600	-634	-684	-684
Net Margin (%)	5.1	16.1	26.1	42.4	47.6	Financing cashflow	-473	-1,274	-2,337	-6,713	-9,199
Core NPAT	272	1,733	3,538	7,998	11,901	Net change in cash	572	-467	812	67	1,442
Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Free cashflow to s/holders	664	818	3,105	6,780	10,641
Reported EPS (\$)	1.59	6.87	14.03	34.83	56.35						
Core EPS (\$)	1.29	8.11	15.58	35.24	56.78						
DPS (\$)	2.80	2.86	2.94	2.96	2.96						
CFPS (\$)	4.36	5.07	16.19	34.11	56.88						
FCFPS (\$)	3.15	3.83	13.68	29.87	50.77						
BVPS (\$)	-7.61	-2.25	10.73	22.62	35.59						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	209	212	219	225	225						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	211	214	227	227	210						
Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Sales revenue (%)	-11.3	38.9	34.1	53.0	33.1						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	63.9	214.1	109.2	116.7	47.9						
Core NPAT (%)	606.3	537.0	104.2	126.1	48.8						
Core EPS (%)	596.2	527.3	92.3	126.1	61.2						
Balance Sheet (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Cash & cash equiv.	1,358	891	1,704	1,772	3,213						
Accounts receivables	429	959	1,534	2,392	2,931						
Inventory	1,239	1,440	1,571	1,967	2,187						
Net fixed & other tangibles	3,188	3,149	3,530	4,143	4,966						
Goodwill & intangibles	1,219	1,221	1,221	1,221	1,221						
Financial & other assets	306	363	412	412	412						
Total assets	7,739	8,023	9,972	11,907	14,929						
Accounts payable	1,786	1,604	1,748	2,437	2,682						
Short-term debt	479	0	185	185	185						
Long-term debt	5,195	4,995	3,380	2,180	2,180						
Provisions & other liab	1,770	1,877	2,492	2,535	2,693						
Total liabilities	9,230	8,476	7,805	7,337	7,740						
Shareholders' equity	-1,491	-453	2,167	4,570	7,189						
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0						
Total equity	-1,491	-453	2,167	4,570	7,189						
Net debt (Adj)	4,316	4,104	1,861	593	-848						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	na	na	85.9	13.0	-11.8						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click [here](#).

Demand conditions appear exceptionally strong across Seagate's nearline business, with visibility extending. Management stated nearline EB capacity is essentially fully allocated through CY27 and into CY28, with many customers discussing supply through CY29 and beyond, while customer demand signals have continued to improve. The company emphasized it is underserving demand but not enough to constrain data-center buildouts, which management views as an ideal position that strengthens its pricing power. Seagate sees little evidence of double-ordering or inventory accumulation, citing high order velocity and customer deployments that are filling relatively quickly. AI demand is also indirectly benefiting traditional cloud services as enterprises keep data close to AI compute environments, creating a broader storage pull across cloud ecosystems. While direct neocloud exposure remains small today, conversations with neocloud providers are increasing, suggesting another potential future demand vector.

The supply backdrop remains highly favorable, supporting both pricing and margin expansion. Management reiterated that EB growth is driven primarily through areal-density improvements rather than unit growth, allowing capacity increases without materially increasing drive componentry. Pricing remains the primary margin lever, aided by contractual pricing ladders that reward transitions to higher-capacity drives and by favorable mix shifts toward latest-gen HAMR products. Mgmt emphasized its commitment to preserving pricing discipline, preferring to moderate supply growth rather than risk oversupplying the market. The company does not foresee adding greenfield manufacturing capacity in the near or medium term, noting that power availability, GPUs, and HBMs remain larger data-center concerns than HDDs at this point. Looking further out, management views physical AI, autonomous systems, and robotics as potentially significant storage catalysts as they generate vast amounts of unstructured sensor and video data, and suggested these trends support its current 25% EB CAGR outlook.

Short-Term View on Seagate Technology Holdings PLC (STX.N)

Direction: Upside
Duration: Within 90 Days (expires 11 Oct 2026)
Date Added: 13 Jul 2026
Category: Earnings

We have an upside 90-day ST View on STX shares on the continuation of solid supply/demand dynamics and improving pricing dynamics. AI demand continues to drive higher content creation, and is accelerating the generation of unstructured data, then stored, duplicated and versioned across collaboration platforms. Any improvement in KV caching is expected to further improve memory bottlenecks and drive growth in inferencing/storage. Moreover, we expect progressively meaningful GM ramp given the company's ramp of Mozaic 4+ beginning in MarQ and building into FY27. This constructive outlook comes on the heels of strong MarQ execution as the company continues to benefit from strong demand for its high-capacity drives, in addition to robust margins and a continued healthy pricing environment well-supported by limited production, ongoing hyperscaler HAMR qualifications, and where the company continues to undersell industry demand.

Seagate Technology Holdings PLC

Company description

Seagate Technology is a global data storage supplier that generates >92% of revenue from the sale of hard disk drives (HDDs), with the remainder from non-HDD based storage (Enterprise Systems, Flash, and Other). The company's products include HDDs, solid state drives (SSDs), solid state hybrid drives, peripheral component interconnect express cards, serial advanced technology attachment controllers, storage subsystems, and computing solutions. As of the latest reported FY, Seagate's OEM customers accounted for 80% of its revenue, with Distributors and Retail customers accounting for 12% and 8% of revenue, respectively. Geographically, 49% of sales were generated in the Americas, 10% in EMEA, and 41% in Asia Pacific. Seagate was founded in 1978 and is headquartered in Dublin, Ireland, with executive offices in Fremont, CA, and had 30,000 employees as of June 2025.

Investment strategy

We rate Seagate shares a Buy. Our Buy rating is underpinned by our view of a cyclical recovery in the HDD market from enterprise/hyperscalers which, coupled with our view of AI-driven storage demand growth, rational capacity additions, and HAMR-led cost improvements, should enable Seagate to sustain higher revenue and earnings growth ahead and resume a higher pace of shareholder returns.

Valuation

Our target price for STX is \$1,300. We value STX at 23x FY28 EPS estimates, on more durable pricing and demand datapoints, and reflective of improving margins, continued execution, and both strong and improving HDD fundamentals.

Risks

Downside risks that could impede the stock price from reaching our target price include:

- 1) returning weakness in cloud/enterprise demand from macro-induced factors could curtail storage spending, and upset the current balance in supply-demand dynamics and causing significant underutilization charges;
- 2) a decrease in SSD prices due to faster-than-expected HDD cannibalization by SSDs;
- 3) continued challenges in improving cost structure vs. the 10-15% historically; and
- 4) HAMR industry adoption stalls and competitive threats to Seagate's enterprise business from Western Digital's ePMR high-capacity drives.

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Appendix A-1

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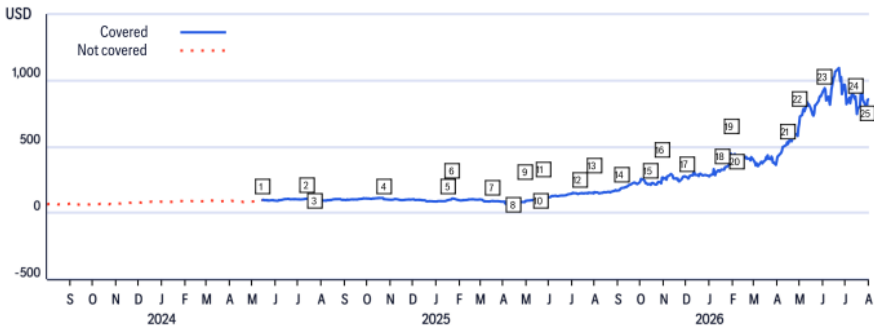
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Seagate Technology Holdings PLC (STX)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Asiya Merchant, CFA



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 14-May-24 03:30:00	*1	*110.00	96.24
2 12-Jul-24 03:00:00	1	*120.00	107.10
3 23-Jul-24 23:30:42	1	*125.00	105.35
4 23-Oct-24 01:19:09	1	*130.00	103.51
5 17-Jan-25 04:00:00	1	*120.00	97.68
6 21-Jan-25 23:07:17	1	*125.00	101.29
7 17-Mar-25 16:41:16	1	*115.00	90.52
8 14-Apr-25 05:00:00	1	*90.00	72.61
9 30-Apr-25 01:28:25	1	*105.00	91.02

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
10 19-May-25 10:00:00	1	*125.00	109.07
11 23-May-25 02:34:09	1	*140.00	112.77
12 11-Jul-25 04:00:00	1	*170.00	147.20
13 30-Jul-25 01:37:03	1	*167.00	147.40
14 07-Sep-25 21:24:48	1	*215.00	188.10
15 13-Oct-25 00:10:56	1	*250.00	219.56
16 29-Oct-25 03:00:31	1	*275.00	265.66
17 01-Dec-25 23:07:43	1	*320.00	270.09
18 19-Jan-26 19:00:00	1	*385.00	326.59

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
19 28-Jan-26 01:22:09	1	*460.00	443.04
20 05-Feb-26 19:00:00	1	*480.00	405.68
21 13-Apr-26 03:59:36	1	*595.00	513.14
22 29-Apr-26 00:33:40	1	*740.00	643.66
23 02-Jun-26 06:01:17	1	*1,150.00	926.80
24 13-Jul-26 03:42:28	1	*1,240.00	860.44
25 29-Jul-26 00:48:52	1	*1,300.00	764.36

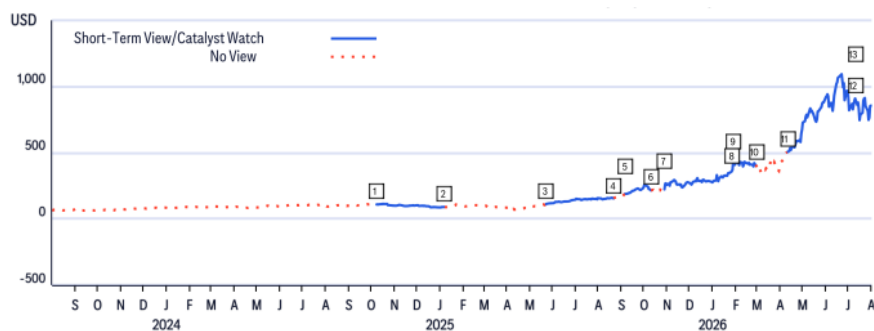
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Seagate Technology Holdings PLC (STX)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Asiya Merchant, CFA



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price		Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price		Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	08-Oct-24 16:00:00	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	108.68	6	12-Oct-25 20:10:56	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	214.40	11	12-Apr-26 23:59:36	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	503.04
2	07-Jan-25 06:28:12	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	89.54	7	28-Oct-25 23:00:31	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	222.59	12	10-Jul-26 14:21:07	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	909.10
3	22-May-25 22:34:09	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	108.67	8	27-Jan-26 06:11:49	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	372.02	13	12-Jul-26 23:42:28	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	909.10
4	21-Aug-25 08:19:08	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	154.55	9	27-Jan-26 20:22:09	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	372.02						
5	07-Sep-25 17:24:48	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	188.10	10	27-Feb-26 06:27:36	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	407.87						

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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Data current as of 01 Jul 2026	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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